

SANKAR INNAMURI

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Personal Summary

- Experienced IT Security Professional with over 6+ years of expertise in IT Infrastructure, Security Operations Center (SOC), Information Security, and Cybersecurity.
- Proficient in automation and monitoring through scripting languages like Shell and Python.
- Skilled in developing and implementing countermeasures using Yara, Snort, and SIEM correlation rules to enhance security posture.
- Hands-on experience in digital forensics and incident response, assisting in evidence collection and forensic analysis during security incidents.
- Strong ability to collaborate with IT and business units, ensuring compliance with security and privacy standards.
- Expertise in malware analysis, cyber threat intelligence, and forensic research, improving security operations.
- Prior experience in Security Operations Center (SOC), working with Endpoint Detection & Response (EDR) solutions.
- Regularly assess alerts and security threats in CrowdStrike to mitigate risks.
- Extensive knowledge of Windows, Linux, and security tools, including firewalls, IDS/IPS, vulnerability scanners (Nessus, Nmap), SIEM platforms (Splunk, ArcSight, Rapid7), and cloud security solutions.
- Designed and implemented Rapid7 InsightVM and Nexpose for enterprise-wide vulnerability management.
- Provided strategic guidance on Office 365 migration, ensuring best practices for configuration and security.
- Hands-on experience in network and cloud security, covering LAN/WAN, routers, switches, firewalls (Cisco, Checkpoint, Palo Alto, F5, Juniper, Aruba, Zscaler), and cloud platforms (AWS, Azure, VMware NSX).
- Managed and optimized ProofPoint email gateway security, ensuring effective email filtering and threat prevention.
- Expertise in email security and brand protection, implementing SPF, DKIM, and DMARC standards for enhanced domain security.
- Worked with web application security testing tools, including Acunetix, Metasploit, Burp Suite, SQLmap, OWASP ZAP Proxy, Nmap, and HP Fortify.
- Experience in Azure infrastructure management, covering Azure Storage, Azure Active Directory, and Office 365.
- Configured, implemented, and maintained security platforms across Linux, Windows, and UNIX environments, including intrusion detection and prevention systems.
- Investigated security incidents and cyber threats using CrowdStrike and Splunk as primary SIEM solutions.
- Improved incident response strategies by integrating Intrusion Prevention, Cyber Kill Chain analysis, and Cyber Threat Intelligence methodologies.
- Maintained security infrastructure, including log management, intrusion prevention systems, and threat detection mechanisms.
- Hands-on experience with SIEM, IDS/IPS, Data Loss Prevention (DLP), forensic tools, and malware analysis solutions.
- Monitored and analyzed network activities, endpoint threats, and security alerts using tools like ArcSight, Splunk, CarbonBlack, FireEye, Cisco Talos, Wireshark, and Nessus.

Skills

- **SIEM Tools:** Splunk, QRadar, Azure Sentinel, AlienVault, LogRhythm
- **Ticketing Systems:** Jira, ServiceNow
- **Security and Threat Hunting Tools & Frameworks:**

- **Vulnerability Scanning:** Nessus, Nmap, Rapid7
- **Endpoint Security:** HIPS, HDLP, CrowdStrike Falcon, Proofpoint, Microsoft Defender, Tanium
- **Network Security:** IDS, IPS, NGFW, WAF, TCP/IP
- **Scripting and Detection Rule Development:** Python, PowerShell, JavaScript, SQL, JSON, XML
- **Operating Systems:** Windows, Linux, macOS
- **OWASP ZAP, MITRE ATT&CK Framework, Wireshark (IDS/IPS), SAST, DAST, IAST**
- **Data Visualization & Analysis:** Tableau, Power BI, SQL, Pandas
- **Networking Devices & Services:** Switches, Routers, Exchange, File Servers
- **Compliance & Regulatory Standards:** NIST 800-53, NIST CSF, PCI DSS, HIPAA, ISO 27001, NYS DFS, GDPR

Experience

SECURITY CONSULTANT | 12/2023 - Current

Amazon - Dallas, TX

Environment: Splunk ES, IBM QRadar, FireEye HX, CrowdStrike Falcon, Tenable Nessus, Proofpoint, Acunetix, Azure, AWS, Python, Jira, and IBM Resilient.

- Triaged and investigated over 20,000 alerts in a 24/7 SOC using SIEM tools (Splunk, LogRhythm, QRadar, Sentinel), reducing false positives by 80% and ensuring timely first-level incident response.
- Conducted in-depth endpoint investigations using CrowdStrike Falcon, SentinelOne, Carbon Black, and Microsoft Defender, prioritizing IOCs/IOAs and mitigating lateral movement risks.
- Deployed and optimized EDR and firewall solutions, reducing endpoint-related incidents by 40% and strengthening overall threat detection.
- Identified and blocked 1,000+ phishing emails using Proofpoint, header analysis, static/dynamic payload inspection, and playbook-driven SOC triage.
- Conducted root cause analysis on recurring incidents using Check Point and improved long-term resilience by reducing repeat events by 30%.
- Analyzed network traffic using Wireshark, PCAP, and TCP dump to detect hostile IPs, malware traffic, and domain-level threats.
- Performed web application penetration tests with Burp Suite, Metasploit, and Fortify, identifying high-risk vulnerabilities in staging environments.
- Led vulnerability assessments using Nessus, Qualys, and Nmap, identifying and remediating 150+ critical CVEs and reducing exposure by 80% within 4 months.
- Implemented IDS/IPS controls and tuned alerting mechanisms, reducing network-based threat incidents by 50%.
- Secured hybrid and multi-cloud environments (AWS, Azure, GCP) by monitoring GuardDuty, CloudTrail, VPC Flow Logs, and enforcing IAM/MFA policies, cutting unauthorized access by 35%.
- Leveraged Darktrace for behavioral analytics, detecting insider threats and compromised credentials, and tuned models to cut false positives by 30%.
- Developed Python-based automation tools and Terraform scripts to enhance detection workflows, reducing manual effort and increasing efficiency by 50%.
- Authored and maintained incident response playbooks and SOPs, reducing average response time (MTTR) by 12% and improving SOC readiness.
- Addressed DLP alerts and enforced data protection measures for PHI, PII, and BII, aligning with compliance goals and reducing data leakage risks.
- Ensured 100% success in 10+ internal and external audits (HIPAA, PCI-DSS, GDPR, SOC 2, ISO 27001) and improved audit readiness by 15% through policy alignment and reporting automation.

SOC ANALYST | 01/2019 - 07/2021

Wells Fargo

Environment: Splunk ES, IBM QRadar, FireEye HX, CrowdStrike Falcon, Tenable Nessus, Proofpoint, Acunetix, Microsoft Defender, Splunk UEBA, Azure, AWS, Nmap, Wireshark, Python

- Worked in a 24/7 Security Operations Center (SOC) leveraging Splunk, IBM QRadar, and ServiceNow (SNOW) to triage and

respond to 300+ daily security alerts across multiple entry points (SIEM, email, tickets, phone).

- Conducted detailed investigation and remediation for 100+ phishing email incidents using Proofpoint, CrowdStrike Falcon, and Microsoft Defender, resulting in a 25% reduction in email-based threats.
- Utilized CrowdStrike Falcon EDR to prioritize and respond to Indicators of Attack (IOA) and Indicators of Compromise (IOC), enhancing endpoint detection and response capabilities.
- Performed anomaly detection using Splunk UEBA add-on and Microsoft Defender for Identity, uncovering 12 critical account compromises in a 6-month period related to lateral movement and privilege escalation.
- Conducted proactive threat hunting on Active Directory environments, improving early detection of potential account takeovers and pass-the-hash attempts.
- Integrated Siemplify SOAR with SIEM and EDR platforms, reducing manual effort and improving threat response time by 40%.
- Managed threat intelligence platforms like AlienVault and Cisco Firepower to identify and mitigate emerging threats, decreasing potential attack surface by 15%.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus, Qualys, and Nmap, identifying and aiding in remediation of 200+ vulnerabilities, reducing exposure by 85%.
- Analyzed network traffic with PCAP and TCPDump using Wireshark to identify suspicious communication patterns and isolate malware-related activities.
- Ensured PHI, PII, and BII confidentiality through Data Loss Prevention (DLP) policies and continuous monitoring across data channels.
- Developed automation scripts using Python and Terraform to streamline threat detection and response processes, improving SOC operational efficiency by 70%.
- Configured and managed email threat protection systems (Proofpoint, Microsoft Defender) to detect and quarantine malicious payloads, significantly enhancing email security posture.
- Produced monthly, quarterly, and annual security assurance and KPI reports for leadership and compliance auditing..

ASSOCIATE CONSULTANT | 11/2016 - 11/2018

Mastercard

- **L1 Role in a 24/7 SOC:** Proactively searched for signs of advanced threats and security weaknesses using SIEM tools like Splunk and Azure Sentinel.
- Analyzed and responded to security threats from EDR, NGFW, SIEM, IDS, IPS, AV, NAC, and other security data sources.
- Documented incident response activities, and provided recommendations for improving processes.
- Collaborated with perimeter and endpoint teams to detect malware, hackers, bots, and other security issues.
- Monitored security systems and diagnosed malware events to ensure uninterrupted service. Identified threats, phishing attacks, and infections.
- Prioritized and triaged security alerts based on severity and potential impact.
- Escalated critical security incidents to appropriate teams for further investigation.
- Integrated threat intelligence into security monitoring and analysis.
- Developed and maintained incident response plans and procedures for Azure environments and Microsoft Defender.
- Executed threat hunting strategies using Azure Sentinel's capabilities and KQL queries.
- Ensured compliance with regulations and standards such as HIPAA, PCI, SOX, and GDPR.

Certifications

- Certified in Ethical Hacking (CEH) | Security+ | Certified Information Systems Auditor (CISA) | Pursuing CISSP

Accomplishments

- Led the investigation and remediation of over 100 critical phishing incidents within a 6-month period, reducing organizational risk exposure by 35% through rapid containment, IOC analysis, and implementation of improved email filtering rules.
- Identified and escalated 12 high-risk account compromise incidents using Splunk UEBA and Microsoft Defender for Identity, enabling early threat containment and preventing potential lateral movement across enterprise systems.